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W E D N E S D A Y , M A Y 1 3 , 2 0 2 6

Research expands ties of Harvard to slavery

259 officials enslaved more than 1,600 people; project ‘just getting started’

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

Between the founding of Harvard University in 1636 and the defeat of the Confederacy 229 years later, the university’s top leaders enslaved more than 1,600 people.

That revelation, contained in a database released by Harvard Tuesday, vastly expands the known ties between the country’s preeminent university and its most ignominious institution: slavery.

Harvard says its investigation is ongoing, and the final tally of people enslaved by Harvard officials is likely to be many times greater than the 1,613 identified so far.

“It could be 100x, it could be 5x,” said Lindsay Fulton, the chief research officer at American Ancestors, the Boston-based genealogy group carrying out the research.

The researchers have identified nearly 3,000 university leaders, faculty, staff, and board members from the relevant centuries who potentially could have owned slaves. So far, they have confirmed that at least 259 definitively did — and are still digging through wills, church documents, municipal records, and Harvard’s own archives in a search that is certain to unearth further ties.

“We are just getting started on what’s going to be a very comprehensive research project,” said

HARVARD, Page A6

Record number of citizens look to leave US

It’s not just politics. Costs, health care access also key.

By Christopher Muther
GLOBE STAFF

For the past decade, studies have indicated Americans’ desire to move abroad. But new analysis shows that the number is quickly accelerating. According to the Pew Research Center, an estimated 180,000 US citizens emigrated in 2025.

It was the largest outbound migration of US citizens in decades.

Because the US government does not officially track the number of residents living or moving abroad, the figure is often compiled from various sources. In this case, Global Citizen Solutions, a residency and citizenship planning advisory firm, analyzed surveys and figures from multiple sources and determined that a record number of US residents are considering living abroad, or have already departed.

The only official numbers are from the US Treasury Department. It publishes quarterly lists of individuals who have formally relinquished their citizenship. Before 2009, renunciations averaged 200 to 400 per year. It’s estimated that renunciations for 2025 will end up near 5,000. Analysts estimate the global demand for renunciation appointments now exceeds 30,000.

It’s also anticipated the number will grow after the renunciation fee dropped from \$2,350 to \$450 last month.

EMIGRATE, Page A7

Before gunshots, a dire warning

After parole officer said man was armed, suicidal, police raced to track him down

By Lea Skene,
Travis Andersen,
and John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

Less than two hours before the Memorial Drive shooting that terrorized drivers and left two people with life-threatening injuries Monday afternoon, a Massachusetts pa-

role officer contacted Boston police with a concerning report: Tyler Brown was suicidal and armed with an assault rifle.

The parole officer called 911 and requested a well-being check on Brown at his home in Dorchester, setting off a race to find an unstable person with a violent history.

Brown was recently released

from a psychiatric hospital and was reportedly using crack cocaine, according to court documents. His record included an incident in 2020 in which he shot at Boston police officers, a case that later raised questions about the relatively lenient sentence he received.

On the phone with his parole officer around noon Monday, Brown said he “had relapsed and was ready to end his life,” police later wrote in an arrest report. “He had a drug screen test scheduled that

day.”

When officers arrived at the home on Mora Street in Dorchester around 12:30 p.m. and discovered Brown wasn’t there, they pinged his phone, tracking it to Cambridge, according to dispatch records.

An internal bulletin distributed within the Boston Police Department warned Brown was “in possession of an assault rifle and stated that he intended to use it.” The memo also referenced the 2020 in-

SHOOTING, Page A7

‘It became very clear that rural Vermont was not going to stand for this.’

REPRESENTATIVE ROB NORTH, *a Ferrisburgh Republican*



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Neil Ryan, walking his land in Corinth, Vt., is one of the leaders in a movement against a law restricting rural changes.

A RURAL REVOLT RUMBLES OVER HILLS OF VERMONT

Land owners say legislators ignored them with law. They’re being heard now.

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

CABOT, Vt. — When Caitlin and Ian Ackermann cobbled together enough money to buy a 27-acre sugarbush here in their early 20s, they were living in a trailer in the woods with no water or electricity.

“We had nothing to our name,” Caitlin Ackermann said.

But they did have hustle. And after 14 years of tapping trees, boiling the sap, and trucking it to farmers markets outside of Boston, they’ve built a maple sugaring business that can sustain their growing family.

And now the Ackermanns are trying to ensure that other young Vermonters can also find a way to live off the land, by repealing a new law they fear could constrict growth in rural Vermont and devalue properties such as theirs. With a ragtag group of fellow political novices, they’re on the verge of unlikely success.

“Land for us is our wealth — 100 percent of our wealth,” Caitlin Ackermann said, standing outside the

VERMONT, Page A10



“Most Vermonters have no idea what’s coming,” warned Ryan, who raises cattle along with other animals, including ducks.

New plan would still dump sewage into Charles River



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Water lilies floated in the murky water of the Charles River at the Harry Parker Boathouse dock in Boston.

Most outflows halted by 2050, officials contend

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

When heavy downpours inundate Boston’s antiquated sewer infrastructure, sewage surges into the Charles and other rivers.

It flows over an Arlington bike path where children ride and parents push strollers, and fills the air with the smell of rotten eggs and garbage. It keeps devoted rowers off the Charles and leaves those who do go out with nausea and

stomach pain. It dumps used toilet paper and tampons on residents’ backyards.

The problem is only getting worse with climate change as more frequent and intense storms drive up rainfall. In 2021, an especially wet year, more than 120 million gallons of sewage and stormwater flowed into the Charles, about the volume of 200 Olympic-size swimming pools.

Don’t expect this to change anytime soon. In the face of these challenges, officials responsible for the overflow sites recently announced a new plan: keep dumping sewage — but far less often.

SEWAGE, Page A10



Inflation increased at a **3.8%** annual rate in April.

(Not seasonally adjusted) **B5.**



Scientists hope a drug nearing approval could be the most significant advance in cancer treatment in 15 years; it targets tumors in the pancreas, lungs, and colon. **A2.**

A Roxbury housing project taps into two funds — one state, the other from Boston — to help turn an idea into reality. **B5.**

Rex Reed dies. The acerbic film critic was 87. **C9.**



A stop shine

Wednesday: Lots of clouds. High 60-65, low 51-56.

Thursday: Lots of rain.

Weather and comics, **G6-7.** Obituaries, **C7.**

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